

TARU Brand Identity Guidelines

Sep 29, 2026 · @Anvesha

TARU is a premium ethnic-wear brand for Indian men aged 40–60, made only from fibres that can legally carry a certified-organic claim. Its identity is built on one idea: **a garment should be able to prove what it says about itself.**

How to read this document

Status: v0.2, capstone deliverable D6 (brand book). TARU is a fictional brand built for an independent capstone project; it will not launch. The book is written in-world, as a real brand book would be, so every choice can be judged against the research. Steps only a live launch would need (trademark clearance, printed colour proofs, mill lab dips, certified suppliers) are listed in Appendix C as out of scope, not as tasks. Three things are still open and are marked **[Pending evidence]** wherever they appear:

Open question	Decided by	Where it changes this document
Which proof leads: certification alone, or benefit + traceability	Claim test, survey Block C	Messaging pillar order; hero lines
Whether "certified organic" leads or supports	Kano, survey Block E	Positioning frame of reference
Which visual route people choose	Brand-route vote, survey Block F	Section 3 may shift toward Route 2 or 3

The compliance rule governs every page. No claim appears in any TARU material, mock-ups included, unless it has a row in the claims substantiation matrix (D7). Words the regulation brief bans (unqualified "eco-friendly", "sustainable", "natural", "chemical-free", "first", "only") appear here only inside the Don't columns.

Disclaimer. TARU is a fictional brand created for an independent student portfolio project. Market, competitor and regulatory facts come from public sources as cited. Consumer findings come from the author's own research with a convenience sample. Costs, targets and financial projections are illustrative assumptions.

1. Brand foundation and purpose

TARU exists to turn "organic", a claim no buyer can check by touch, into something a man can verify in ten seconds with his phone. Everything else in this system serves that job.

1.1 Name and core philosophy

TARU (तरु) is Sanskrit for *tree*. The name was chosen for what a tree does, not how it looks.

- **A tree carries its own record.** Its age and its hard years can be read in its growth rings. It is one of the few things in nature that proves its history without anyone vouching for it.
- **A tree is where elders sit.** The banyan and the peepal are the village meeting places where older men are heard. TARU dresses that generation.
- **A family tree.** Ethnic wear is bought for weddings, pujas and family functions, where a man stands as the trunk his family branches from.

Core philosophy: proof, grown in rings. Each stage of a TARU garment (farm, gin, mill, garment) is treated as one ring. Each ring is certified and can be read on the garment's QR proof page. The visual identity, the tag and the voice all repeat this structure.

Attribute	Decision
Name	TARU, always in capitals in the wordmark; "Taru" in running text
Script	Latin wordmark primary; तरु (Devanagari) as the secondary mark for tags, packaging and Hindi communication
Pronunciation	TUH-roo (both vowels short)
Essence (internal, two words)	Provable comfort
Tagline status	Starting line "Rooted in nature. Refined by time." is on hold : "nature" is a generic environmental term under CCPA 2024 and needs its own D7 row. Candidates to test are in section 2.3

1.2 Vision and mission

Vision. An India where what a man wears to the moments that matter can be traced, checked and trusted.

Mission. We make certified-organic ethnic wear for men in the second half of life: cut for the bodies they have, comfortable through the longest function, and able to prove every claim on its tag.

The mission has three testable parts, each tied to a research question:

Mission clause	What must be true	How we will know
"Cut for the bodies they have"	A size and pattern system graded for fuller and mature builds	Kano class of "cut for fuller builds"; fit complaints in the review whitespace map
"Comfortable through the longest function"	Fabric and construction that stay comfortable over 6+ hours	Documented wear trial before any public comfort claim
"Prove every claim on its tag"	GOTS licence, transaction certificates and a live QR trail per SKU	Claims matrix (D7) row for every public claim

1.3 Core values

Each value names what it costs us. A value that costs nothing is a slogan.

Value	What it means	How it shows up	What we give up for it
Proof before promise	No claim ships without evidence a stranger can check	Licence number on every tag; QR trail; claims matrix	Generic green language; launching a fabric before its certificate arrives
Fit is respect	A 55-year-old body is the design brief, not an exception	Patterns graded for fuller builds; free alterations; real models aged 40–65	The cheaper single-block pattern most brands use
Quiet over loud	Understatement in design, voice and selling	Restrained palette; no hype words; no discount-led selling on ceremonial lines	Trend drops, influencer spikes, flash sales
Made to be handed down	Garments built to be altered and worn for decades	Extra seam allowance for alterations; reinforced stress points; repair service	Seasonal obsolescence and its repeat sales

Value	What it means	How it shows up	What we give up for it
Fair to the chain	Long partnerships with certified units, fairly paid	Named partners on the proof page	The lowest-cost supplier each season

Note on "Fair to the chain": this is an internal value. It becomes a public claim only if a relevant social certification is in place and has its own D7 row.

1.4 Non-negotiables

These are hard rules. Breaking one requires the founder's written sign-off and a decision-log entry.

1. No claim appears anywhere without a row in the claims substantiation matrix (D7).
2. "Organic" is used only on garments meeting the GOTS $\geq 95\%$ grade; "made with X% organic" only at $\geq 70\%$. Bamboo viscose and lyocell are never called organic.
3. Every tag carries the certifier name and licence number, or no certification claim at all.
4. No AI-generated testimonials, reviews, customer faces or endorsements, labelled or not.
5. Campaign imagery shows men aged 40–65, including fuller builds, with age unretouched.
6. No "first", "only" or "India's most" claims. Isha Life already sells an organic cotton men's kurta.
7. No markdowns on the Ceremonial line. A garment for a daughter's wedding is not a sale item.
8. The QR proof page stays live for the life of the garment, and never redirects to a sales page.

1.5 Value proposition

Built on Aaker's three benefit types. Each benefit has a reason to believe and an evidence status.

Benefit type	The benefit	Reason to believe	Evidence status
Functional	Ethnic wear that fits a mature build and stays comfortable through a long function	Graded pattern block; certified organic cotton and linen; free alterations	Fit: Kano + reviews [Pending evidence] . Comfort: needs a wear trial before any public claim

Benefit type	The benefit	Reason to believe	Evidence status
Functional	Proof you can check yourself	GOTS licence on the tag; QR to transaction certificates, farm to garment	Buildable now; claim test measures whether it moves trust [Pending evidence]
Emotional	Certainty at an important occasion: nothing itches, nothing needs explaining	Comfort + fit + proof, together	Interview ladders [Pending evidence]
Self-expressive	"I choose carefully, and I don't need to announce it"	Understated design; proof on the inside of the tag, not the outside of the garment	Brand-route vote and interviews [Pending evidence]
For the gifter	A gift that shows care, not just spend	Proof card and alteration voucher in the box	Gifter interviews [Pending evidence]

1.6 Positioning

The frame of reference is the one decision still open. Both versions are written; the survey decides which is used.

Frame A: premium ethnic wear that happens to be certified organic (current lead hypothesis)

For affluent Indian men aged 40–60 who dress with care for the occasions that matter, TARU is the premium ethnic-wear label that can prove what its fabric is made of, because every garment carries its GOTS licence number and a scannable trail from farm to tag, and is cut for the body its wearer actually has.

Frame B: certified-organic clothing, made for India's occasions

For men who already choose organic food and skincare, TARU is certified-organic clothing made for Indian festivals and family functions, because every fibre claim on its tag can be checked against a certificate.

Frame A competes with Manyavar and Tasva and uses organic as the point of difference. Frame B competes with organic lifestyle brands and uses occasion as the point of difference. The Kano result decides: if "certified organic fabric" comes out *Indifferent*,

Frame A stands and comfort and fit lead the copy.

	Points of parity (as good as the leader)	Points of difference (only TARU)
Against Manyavar / Tasva	Finish, occasion range from everyday to ceremonial, sets and Nehru jackets, a trial and alteration experience	Checkable fibre proof; pattern graded for mature builds; no markdown culture on ceremonial
Against Fabindia	Natural-fibre fabrics, craft detail	Certified (not just natural) fibre; occasion and ceremonial range for men; fit system
Against Isha Life and basic organic kurtas	Organic cotton	Licence and trail on the tag; occasion wear; tailoring-grade construction

Competitor facts behind this table are in the category dossier (D1) and the sources register.

2. Brand personality and voice

TARU speaks like a respected elder who has checked the facts: few words, specific, warm without flattery. It proves before it persuades.

2.1 Brand archetypes

	Primary: The Sage	Secondary: The Caregiver
Share of the personality	About 60%	About 40%
Core motivation	Truth that can be verified	Protecting the people who matter
What it gives TARU	The proof system, precise language, the licence number on the tag	Fit for real bodies, comfort through long days, gifting that shows care
How it shows	QR proof page, fibre data set in mono type, calm explanatory copy	Alteration service, generous cuts, family occasions in imagery

	Primary: The Sage	Secondary: The Caregiver
Shadow to avoid	Lecturing, jargon, sounding superior about other people's choices	Sentimentality, guilt, over-promising comfort or health

The combination: "the elder who knows, and cares enough to show you." The Sage alone would feel like a lab report; the Caregiver alone would feel like greeting-card advertising. Together, the evidence is offered as a courtesy, not as a sales argument.

2.2 Personality traits

Each trait is defined by the line it must not cross.

TARU is	...but never	In practice
Assured	Boastful	States facts and lets them stand; no superlatives
Warm	Sentimental	Talks about the occasion and the person, not about feelings in the abstract
Precise	Technical	Gives the number and says what it means: "95% certified organic cotton, the level GOTS requires to call a garment organic"
Rooted	Nostalgic	Heritage is lived today, not a sepia past; no "like our grandfathers wore"
Understated	Cold	Quiet design, but every message ends with something useful to the reader

2.3 Tone of voice

Voice is constant; tone moves with the moment.

Context	Tone	Example
Swing tag and care label	Factual, complete, no adjectives	"Organic cotton. GOTS certified, licence no. [X], certified by [body]. Scan for this garment's trail."

Context	Tone	Example
QR proof page	Plain, step by step, patient	"This fabric was grown in [district], ginned in [town] and woven in [town]. Each step has a certificate; tap one to read it."
Product page	Informative, sensory, specific	"Mid-weight linen with a soft finish. Cut 4 cm fuller through the waist than our standard block, with extra seam allowance for alterations."
Social posts	Conversational, curious, still exact	"What does 'certified organic' actually certify? One post, four steps, no jargon."
Wedding-season campaign	Warm, occasion-first	"For the day you stand next to your son."
Gift messaging	Considerate, understated	"Chosen with care. The proof is inside the box, if he wants it."
Customer service and bad news	Direct, owning the problem, no corporate hedging	"Your order is late because the fabric certificate hadn't cleared. We won't ship until it does. New date: [date]."

Dos and don'ts

Do	Don't	Why
"Organic cotton, GOTS certified. Licence no. [X]."	"Eco-friendly, natural, planet-loving cotton."	Generic terms need qualifiers and evidence (CCPA 2024); the licence number is the qualifier
"Made with 72% organic cotton and 28% linen."	"100% organic" on a blend	GOTS grades: organic $\geq$ 95%, "made with" $\geq$ 70%
"Cut with more room through the chest and waist."	"Slimming cut that hides the belly."	Fit is respect; no body shame
"Scan to see where your fabric came from."	"Totally transparent supply chain."	Show the trail; don't grade yourself

Do	Don't	Why
"Free alterations within 30 days."	"The perfect fit, guaranteed."	A service is checkable; "perfect" is not
"Soft through a six-hour function" only after a documented wear trial	Skin or health promises ("good for sensitive skin", "hypoallergenic")	Performance and health claims need test evidence
Numerals and units: "₹4,500", "6 hours", "95%"	"Affordable luxury", "premium quality"	Specifics build trust; adjectives spend it
Short sentences; one idea each	Exclamation marks, hashtags in body copy, emojis in brand copy	Quiet over loud
Name what the certificate covers: "the fabric" or "the thread"	Certification claims that blur product and packaging	ASCI 2024: state the scope
Talk about his occasions	"India's first certified-organic menswear brand"	Unsubstantiable comparative; also untrue (Isha Life)

Word bank

Words we use	Words we avoid	Reason
certified, licence, trail, grown, woven, cut, fitted, altered, occasion, handed down	eco, green, sustainable, natural, conscious, guilt-free, clean, pure	Generic environmental terms; need qualifiers
proof, check, see for yourself	transparent, honest (about ourselves)	Show it, don't claim it
comfortable, soft, breathable (only with a D7 row)	luxury, premium, exclusive, curated	Adjectives with no evidence
men, fathers, elders by name of role	old, aged, senior citizens	Respect, not labels
alteration, repair, handed down	timeless, iconic, heritage-inspired	Checkable services over mood words

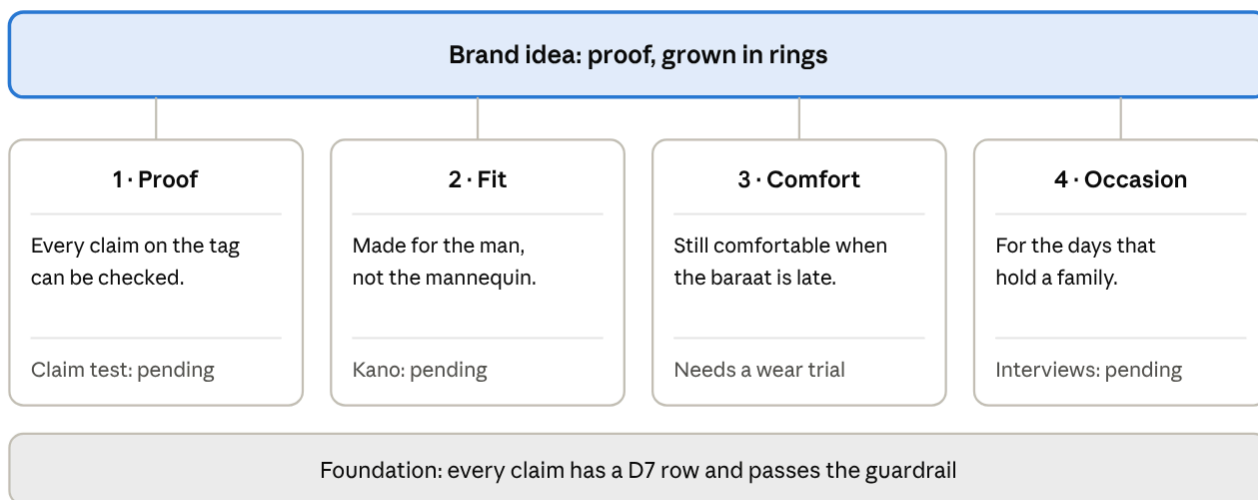
Language and style rules

- **Hindi is written, not translated.** Hindi lines are drafted by a native writer, in Devanagari on tags and packaging. Hinglish is for social and conversation only, never on a tag or proof page.
- **Spelling:** Indian English (colour, centre, licence as a noun). Indian number system (lakh, crore). Rupee as ₹ with no space.
- **Sentence length:** under 20 words on tags, under 25 in body copy. One idea per sentence.
- **Punctuation:** no exclamation marks. Emojis never in brand copy; in customer DMs only if the customer uses them first.
- **Every public line** passes the Claims Guardrail (AI4) and a person before it is published.

2.4 Messaging framework

One brand idea, four pillars, one foundation. The pillar order is **[Pending evidence]**: the claim test decides whether "Proof" or "Comfort" leads.

Every message rests on one idea and one compliance rule



messaging framework · 1 idea, 4 pillars, 1 foundation

The pillars stand on the compliance foundation: a message that can't pass the guardrail doesn't reach any pillar.

Pillar	Core message	Proof points	Evidence status	Leads on
1. Proof you can check	"Every claim on the tag can be checked."	GOTS licence on tag; QR trail with transaction certificates; certifier named	Claim test (B vs A) [Pending evidence]	Tag, QR page, product page
2. Cut for the body you have	"Made for the man, not the mannequin."	Graded block for fuller builds; size range to [X]; free alterations	Kano "fit for fuller builds"; review fit complaints [Pending evidence]	Store, product page, fit guide
3. Comfort through the longest day	"Still comfortable when the baraat is late."	Organic cotton and linen; breathable weaves; wear trial	Needs wear trial before public use	Campaign, product page
4. Made for the moments that hold a family	"For the days you'll see in photographs for thirty years."	Everyday → Festive → Ceremonial range; repair service; no ceremonial markdowns	Interviews, occasion data (survey B1)	Campaign, gifting

By buyer: the self-buyer hears pillars 2 → 3 → 1 (fit and comfort first, proof as reassurance). The gifter hears 4 → 1 → 2 (the occasion, then proof as a sign of care, then fit so the gift gets worn). **[Pending evidence]:** survey segments confirm or reorder this.

Tagline candidates (to test)

Candidate	What it says	Compliance note
Know what you wear.	Proof, plainly	No environmental term; safe
Made to be believed.	Proof as craft	Safe; test comprehension
Every thread, accounted for.	Full traceability	A traceability claim: needs a D7 row and a complete trail for every fibre, including thread

Candidate	What it says	Compliance note
Rooted in nature. Refined by time.	Heritage + nature (the starting line)	"Nature" needs a qualifier or a D7 row; hold

Elevator lines

- **10 words:** Certified-organic ethnic wear for men, cut for real builds.
- **25 words:** TARU makes ethnic wear for men aged 40 to 60 in certified organic cotton and linen, cut for real builds, with proof on every tag.
- **50 words:** Most ethnic wear asks you to trust its label. TARU gives you the label's evidence: a GOTS licence number and a scannable trail from farm to finished garment. The kurtas and sets are cut for mature builds and altered free, for the everyday, the festival and the family wedding.

3. Visual identity system

The identity is built on the cross-section of a tree: concentric rings, each one a certified stage of the garment's life. It looks quiet on purpose. The proof is the ornament.

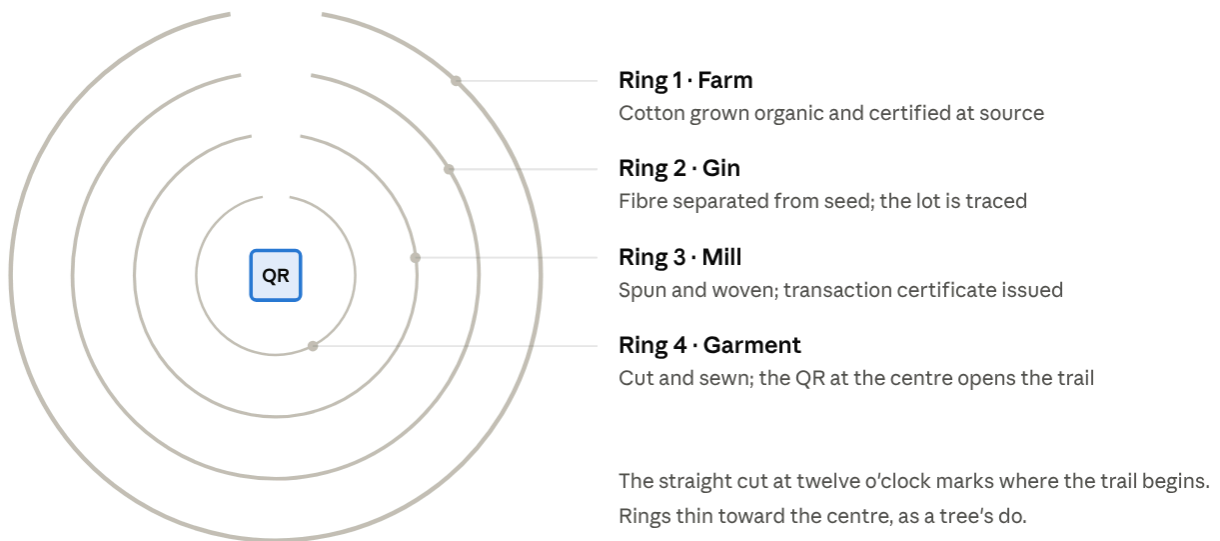
3.1 Visual concept: Heartwood

Heartwood is the dense core of a tree trunk: the oldest wood, and the part that carries the most weight. It is the brand's metaphor for its wearer, the man at the centre of a family, and for its promise, a record laid down ring by ring.

The concept works through three visual devices:

Device	What it is	Where it appears	What it means
The Ring Seal	Four concentric, slightly irregular rings with a small notch cut at the top	Tag, QR frame, packaging closure, favicon	Farm, gin, mill, garment: four certified stages
The Grain Line	A single fine line (0.5 pt / 1 px) that runs through layouts, like wood grain or a tailor's chalk mark	Dividers, tag edges, web section breaks	Continuity: one unbroken chain from farm to garment
The Proof Strip	A band of monospaced data: fibre %, certifier, licence number, trail link	Tag back, product page, packaging base, social proof posts	Evidence shown, not described

Each ring of the seal is one certified stage, read from the outside in



the Ring Seal · 4 rings, 4 certified stages

The seal is a diagram of the proof system: the QR at its centre opens the same four stages the rings stand for.

What the identity refuses. Leaves, globes, hands cupping saplings, recycling arrows, green gradients and sepia "heritage" filters. These are the visual shorthand of greenwashing and of costume nostalgia; they signal a claim without proving it.

3.2 Logo system

The logo pairs the Ring Seal with a Fraunces wordmark. Every lockup below is outlined to vector and delivered as SVG in `brand/logo/`.

TARU logo system

Ring Seal + Fraunces wordmark (opsz 144 · wght 500 · SOFT 30 · WONK 0 · tracking +40), outlined to vector. Clear space = 1 × cap height.



PRIMARY LOCKUP · HEARTWOOD ON KORA



STACKED · BILINGUAL



PRIMARY · KORA ON HEARTWOOD



PRIMARY · INK (ONE-COLOUR)



WORDMARK ONLY



RING SEAL



SEAL + QR ZONE



DEVANAGARI MARK · तरु



LINE · EVERYDAY



LINE · FESTIVE ON INDIGO



LINE · CEREMONIAL ON MADDER

Minimum size: wordmark 18 mm / 72 px wide · seal 8 mm / 24 px. Fictional brand for an independent student portfolio project.

Element	Specification (as built)
Wordmark	TARU in Fraunces, static instance at optical size 144, weight 500, SOFT 30, WONK 0; tracking +40; outlined to paths. A refinement pass (lowering the A's crossbar, straightening the R's leg) is noted but not drawn
Devanagari mark	तरु in Tiro Devanagari Hindi, shaped with HarfBuzz and outlined; sized to sit under the wordmark in the stacked bilingual lockup

Element	Specification (as built)
Ring Seal	Four rings on an outer radius of 100 units: radii 100 / 79 / 60 / 43 (gaps narrowing toward the centre), stroke weights 8 / 6.8 / 5.6 / 4.4. One straight cut, 13 units wide, at twelve o'clock through every ring. Each ring varies in radius by at most 1.2% and its centre is offset by at most 0.6%, so the seal reads as grown, not machined
Primary lockup	Seal left, wordmark right; seal height = $1.6 \times$ cap height; gap = $0.6 \times$ cap height
Stacked lockup	Seal ($2.2 \times$ cap height) above the wordmark, centred; bilingual version adds तारु below. For square formats and packaging lids
Colour versions	Heartwood on Kora (primary) · Kora reversed on Heartwood, Indigo or Madder · Ink one-colour
Clear space	$1 \times$ cap height of the wordmark on every side, for every lockup
Minimum size	Wordmark 18 mm print / 72 px screen. Seal 8 mm / 24 px. Below that, wordmark only; the rings close up
Line descriptors	Everyday, Festive, Ceremonial: IBM Plex Sans 500, uppercase, tracked +120, centred under the wordmark. Descriptors, not sub-brands: one brand, three occasions

Brand architecture decision: a branded house. Sub-brand names were rejected: three new names would split recognition for a brand with no awareness yet, and the lines differ by occasion, not by customer.

Logo misuse. Never:

- stretch, rotate, outline or add effects (shadow, emboss, gradient) to any mark
- set the wordmark in Haldi, Lichen or any colour that fails 4.5 : 1 contrast on its background
- place the seal on a photograph without a solid Kora or Heartwood field behind it
- fill the rings or add a leaf, sprout or globe inside the seal
- use the seal as a certification mark. It is TARU's brand mark; the GOTS label is separate and follows GOTS labelling rules

3.3 Colour palette

The palette is taken from the materials themselves: unbleached cotton, heartwood, natural indigo, madder root, turmeric, raw khadi and lichen. Nothing in it is a "green" cliché: the one green is almost black, a wood colour, not a leaf colour.



Pantone references are the nearest Pantone Coated matches, chosen on screen. For this project the HEX values are the reference. A live brand would confirm them against printed proofs and match fabric colours by mill lab dip (Appendix C).

Primary (about 90% of any layout)

Name	HEX	RGB	Pantone (nearest, verify)	Role
Heartwood	#1F3A2F	31, 58, 47	5535 C	Signature colour: wordmark, seal, headings, dark grounds
Kora Cotton	#F3EEE4	243, 238, 228	7527 C, as a light tint (proof on stock)	The ground: 60% of most layouts; packaging, web background
Ink	#2B2926	43, 41, 38	Black 7 C	Body text, proof strip, fine lines

Secondary (occasion colours, about 8%)

Name	HEX	RGB	Pantone (nearest, verify)	Role
Indigo	#26324D	38, 50, 77	533 C	Festive line; secondary dark ground
Madder	#84302A	132, 48, 42	7623 C	Ceremonial line; wedding-season campaign
Haldi	#C8912F	200, 145, 47	7563 C	Festive and ceremonial highlights; never text on light grounds

Accent (about 2%)

Name	HEX	RGB	Pantone (nearest, verify)	Role
Raw Khadi	#D9C9A8	217, 201, 168	7501 C	Everyday line; secondary light ground; tag stock tint
Lichen	#9DA283	157, 162, 131	5777 C	Everyday line accents; charts on the proof page; never text on light grounds

Usage rules

- **Proportion:** 60% Kora Cotton, 30% Heartwood and Ink, 10% secondary and accent. On dark layouts, swap Heartwood and Kora.

- **One occasion colour per layout.** Everyday = Raw Khadi + Lichen. Festive = Indigo + Haldi. Ceremonial = Madder + Haldi. Never mix two lines' colours in one piece.
- **Text contrast (WCAG 2.2, computed):**

Text colour on background	Contrast ratio	Allowed use
Ink on Kora Cotton	12.5 : 1	All text
Heartwood on Kora Cotton (and reverse)	10.7 : 1	All text
Indigo on Kora Cotton (and reverse)	11.0 : 1	All text
Ink on Raw Khadi	8.9 : 1	All text
Madder on Kora Cotton (and reverse)	7.5 : 1	All text
Heartwood on Raw Khadi	7.6 : 1	All text
Ink on Lichen	5.5 : 1	Body text allowed
Ink on Haldi	5.2 : 1	Body text allowed
Haldi on Heartwood	4.4 : 1	Large text (≥ 24 px, or 19 px bold) and graphics only
Haldi on Kora Cotton	2.4 : 1	Never for text; rules and fills only
Lichen on Kora Cotton	2.3 : 1	Never for text; chart fills and rules only

- **Don't:** use pure white (#FFFFFF) as a ground (Kora Cotton is the white), use gradients, tint photographs in brand colours, or use any green other than Heartwood.
- **Digital states:** links in Heartwood with a 1 px underline; errors in Madder with an icon and words, never colour alone.

3.4 Typography system

Three families, each with one job: Fraunces speaks, IBM Plex Sans explains, IBM Plex Mono proves. All three are free under the SIL Open Font Licence (Google Fonts), so TARU can use them in print, web, app and packaging without licence fees.

Typography

Fraunces speaks · IBM Plex Sans explains · IBM Plex Mono proves. All SIL Open Font Licence.

PRIMARY · DISPLAY

Aa

Fraunces
Variable · opsz 72–144 · wght 400–500 · SOFT 30 · WONK off. Headlines, campaign lines, wordmark.

SECONDARY · TEXT AND UI

Aa

IBM Plex Sans + Devanagari
400 body · 500 labels · 600 buttons and sub-heads. Matching Devanagari cut for bilingual tags.

ACCENT · PROOF DATA

Aa

IBM Plex Mono
400 only. Licence numbers, fibre %, certificate IDs, dates. Never a sentence.

DISPLAY · 56/1.05

For the day you stand next to your son.

H1 · 40/1.15

Know what you wear.

H2 · 28/1.25

Cut for the body you have

H3 · PLEX 600 · 18

Mid-weight linen, festive set

BODY · PLEX 400 · 16/1.55

Mid-weight linen with a soft finish. Cut 4 cm fuller through the waist than our standard block, with extra seam allowance for alterations.

LABEL · PLEX 500 · 12

EVERYDAY · FESTIVE · CEREMONIAL +8%

PROOF · MONO 13

LIC. XX-GOTS-000000 · TC 2026-00000 · 12 SEP 2026

CAPTION · PLEX 12

AI-generated image. Concept only.

HINDI DISPLAY · TIRO DEVANAGARI HINDI

जानिए, आप क्या पहनते हैं ।

HINDI TEXT · IBM PLEX SANS DEVANAGARI

प्रमाणित ऑर्गेनिक कॉटन। लाइसेंस नं. [X]। इस कपड़े का सफ़र देखने के लिए स्कैन करें।

FIBRE 100% ORGANIC COTTON

GOTS

LIC. [X]

CB [BODY]

SCAN FOR TRAIL

PROOF STRIP COMPONENT · ALL FIELDS OR NONE

Role	Typeface	Why it fits	Settings
Primary: display	Fraunces (variable)	A soft, old-style serif with a warmth that reads mature, not antique; the optical-size axis keeps it refined at headline sizes	Optical size 72–144 for headlines; weight 400–500; SOFT 30; WONK off
Secondary: text and UI	IBM Plex Sans + IBM Plex Sans Devanagari	Engineered, plain and very legible; the Devanagari cut matches its Latin, so bilingual tags look like one family	Weight 400 body, 500 labels, 600 buttons

Role	Typeface	Why it fits	Settings
Accent: proof data	IBM Plex Mono	Monospaced type reads as record, not rhetoric; tabular figures line up in certificate tables	Weight 400; used only for data
Hindi display	Tiro Devanagari Hindi	A calligraphic Devanagari with the same bookish warmth as Fraunces	Hindi headlines and the त्र mark base

Hierarchy

Level	Typeface	Print (pt / leading)	Screen (px / line height)	Tracking	Use
Display	Fraunces 400, opsz 144	48 / 52	56 / 1.05	-1%	Campaign lines, packaging lids
H1	Fraunces 500, opsz 72	32 / 38	40 / 1.15	-0.5%	Page titles
H2	Fraunces 500, opsz 36	22 / 28	28 / 1.25	0	Section heads
H3	IBM Plex Sans 600	13 / 18	18 / 1.35	0	Sub-heads, card titles
Body	IBM Plex Sans 400	10 / 15	16 / 1.55	0	Running text
Label	IBM Plex Sans 500, uppercase	7.5 / 10	12 / 1.3	+8%	Line descriptors, nav, tag headers
Proof data	IBM Plex Mono 400	7.5 / 11	13 / 1.5	0	Licence numbers, fibre %, certificate IDs, dates
Caption	IBM Plex Sans 400	7 / 10	12 / 1.4	+1%	Photo credits, AI labels, legal lines

Rules

- Fraunces never below 14 px on screen or 11 pt in print; below that it loses its softness and looks thin.
- Mono is for data only: numbers, codes, certificate references. Never a sentence in mono.
- Uppercase only for labels and descriptors, always tracked +8% or more. Never for headlines or body.
- One display line per layout. If a layout needs two big messages, it needs two layouts.

- **Figures:** proportional old-style in Fraunces headlines; tabular lining in Plex for prices and tables.
- **Fallbacks when a font can't load:** Georgia (display), Arial (text), Courier New (data).

3.5 Design system rules

Grid and space

Rule	Specification
Ring unit (R)	8 px on screen, 2 mm in print. Every margin, gap and padding is a multiple of R
Print grid	12 columns; outer margin 4R (8 mm) on A5 and smaller, 6R (12 mm) on A4 and up; gutter 2R
Screen grid	12 columns desktop (max width 1200 px, gutter 24 px), 4 columns mobile (16 px side margins)
Baseline	4 px on screen; 3 mm in print
White space	At least 40% of any hero layout is empty ground. Space is how the brand says "quiet"
Composition	One focal point per layout. Asymmetric: text holds the left third, image or seal the right two-thirds, or the reverse. Never centred-everything
Grain Line	0.5 pt / 1 px in Ink or Heartwood; runs edge to edge or stops on a grid line, never floats

Components

- **Proof Strip:** Ink text in IBM Plex Mono on Raw Khadi or Kora, 2R padding, fields separated by a thin vertical rule: FIBRE 100% ORGANIC COTTON | GOTS | LIC. [X] | CB [BODY] | SCAN FOR TRAIL. Always carries every field or none; a partial strip implies proof that isn't there.
- **Ring Seal + QR:** the QR code sits inside the seal's innermost ring on tags and packaging. Minimum QR size 18 mm, with quiet zone intact; test-scan on three phones before print.
- **Icons:** line icons at 1.25 px stroke, round caps, drawn on a 24 px grid; no filled icons, no leaf or globe icons.
- **Pattern:** the Ring Seal repeated as a field at 4–6% opacity (Heartwood on Kora) for tissue, box lining and web backgrounds. Never behind body text.

- **Texture:** a scanned khadi weave may be used as a ground at $\leq 8\%$ contrast. Never a stock "paper" texture.

Imagery and photography

Photography carries two messages the words can't: that the clothes fit real bodies, and that the fabric is what it claims to be. Its first rule is honesty.

Area	Guideline
Casting	Men aged 40–65 as the lead; at least one fuller build in every set of three images; skin tones across India's range, unlightened. Grey hair, lines and weight stay as they are. Gifters (25–40) appear only beside the lead, never instead of him
Fit honesty	No clips, pins or tape pulling fabric tight behind the model. The garment is shown as it fits off the rail, in the model's real size
Light	Natural daylight: north-facing window light for everyday; late-afternoon warm light for festive; warm practical light (diyas, bulbs) for ceremonial evenings. No hard flash, no ring lights
Setting	Real homes, courtyards, verandas, family functions, workplaces. No studio seamless for people; no staged luxury sets
Moments	Mid-action and unposed: adjusting a cuff, greeting a relative, sitting through a long ceremony. Never looking at the camera to sell
Grading	Warm neutral, true to the fabric's colour; lifted blacks no more than 5%. No teal-orange looks, no sepia, no desaturated "heritage" filters
Product	Flat lays on Kora-coloured linen, 45° softbox, a colour-checker card in the first frame of every shoot. Macro of the weave at 1:1 for every fabric. True colour cuts returns: the photo is part of the product's claim
Proof imagery	Real farm, gin, mill and workshop photographs from certified partners, with names and places captioned. No stock farm photography, ever

Area	Guideline
AI-generated imagery	Allowed for mood boards and concept cards only (section 4), always labelled "AI-generated image". Never for product listings, never to depict customers or partners, never with a real person's likeness

Motion

Slow and settled: 300–400 ms, ease-out. The Ring Seal draws from its centre outward, one ring at a time, when a proof page loads: the stages of the garment's life appear in order. No bounces, no parallax, no autoplaying sound.

4. AI image generation prompts

These five prompts produce concept and placeholder images: mood boards, pitch cards, survey routes and layout comps. They are not a substitute for the campaign shoot, and no AI image ever shows a product listing, a customer or a supply-chain partner.

4.1 Rules for every AI image

Rule	Why
Label every published AI image "AI-generated image" in the caption style (section 3.4)	IT Amendment Rules 2026; ASCI synthetic-content guidelines (final, 29 Sep 2026)
No real person's likeness; no "in the style of" a named living designer or photographer	Deepfake and copyright prohibitions; brand integrity
No text, logos or QR codes generated in-image; add the wordmark, labels and a real QR in post	Models render text badly, and a fake QR implies proof that isn't there
Check the model's licence allows commercial use before using any output publicly	Image rights
Log every generation: prompt ID, model and version, seed, date, output file	Traceability; the AI6 bias audit

Rule	Why
Audit people images for age, build and skin tone against the prompt (Monk Skin Tone scale); regenerate or fix the prompt when the model drifts	Models tend to make "men aged 55" look 35 and to slim fuller builds
Colour-correct every output to the palette before use	AI colour drifts toward saturated greens and teal-orange

Midjourney parameters used below: `--ar` aspect ratio, `--style raw` (less stylised, more photographic), `--stylize` low for fidelity, `--no` exclusions. `--v 7` was current at the time of writing; set it to the latest version you have. For DALL·E or other natural-language models, use the second block of each prompt.

Prompt 1: Core hero product line

Purpose: the three occasion lines together, for the brand book cover, the pitch deck and the web hero comp. **Format:** 16:9 landscape.

Editorial still-life photograph of three Indian men's garments hung side by side on dark teak wooden hangers from a single brass rail, against a warm off-white limewashed wall. Left: an everyday straight-cut kurta in unbleached ivory organic cotton, mandarin collar, fabric-covered buttons, visible slub texture. Centre: a festive kurta in deep natural indigo linen, paired with a sleeveless Nehru jacket in raw beige handloom khadi, horn buttons. Right: a ceremonial bandhgala-style long jacket and kurta in deep madder-red handwoven cotton-linen, subtle tonal self-stripe weave, hand-felled hems, no embroidery, no metallic thread. Garments cut generously for a mature, fuller build, relaxed drape, natural creases. Soft north-facing window light from the left, gentle shadow gradients on the wall, a thin line of late light across the floor. Matte, tactile fabrics, true-to-life colour, quiet luxury, restrained composition with generous negative space on the right third. Shot on medium format, 80mm lens, f/8, high detail on weave and stitching `--ar 16:9 --style raw --stylize 80 --v 7 --no text, logo, watermark, mannequin, model, silk sheen, gold zari, sequins, embroidery, leaves, plants, green tint, clutter`

A photorealistic editorial still-life, 16:9 landscape. Three Indian men's garments hang side by side on dark teak hangers from a brass rail in front of a warm off-white limewashed wall. On the left, an everyday straight kurta in unbleached ivory cotton with a mandarin collar and fabric-covered buttons. In the centre, a deep indigo linen festive kurta with a sleeveless raw-beige khadi Nehru jacket with horn buttons. On the right, a ceremonial bandhgala-style long jacket and kurta in deep madder-red handwoven cotton-linen with a subtle tonal stripe, no embroidery and no metallic thread. The cuts are generous, made for a mature, fuller build. Soft window light from the left, natural shadows, matte tactile fabric texture, true colour, lots of empty space on the right. No people, no mannequins, no plants, no text or logos.



AI-generated image. Concept only.

Output review: use. It matches the brief: three lines in the right colour order, brass rail, limewashed wall, window light, and a clear right third for the wordmark. Hanger labels came out blank, as intended. One fix: the madder jacket's stripe reads as bright rust thread, bolder than "subtle tonal", and at thumbnail size it could pass for zari. Tone the stripe down in post, or regenerate with "tone-on-tone stripe, same colour as the ground".

Post-production: colour-match the three garments to Kora Cotton, Indigo + Raw Khadi, and Madder; check button counts and placket construction are plausible; add the wordmark in the empty right third.

Prompt 2: Product packaging and mockups

Purpose: the unboxing system in one frame, for the brand book packaging page and supplier briefs. **Format:** 4:5 portrait.

Top-down three-quarter view product mockup of a premium clothing packaging set on a pale raw-linen tabletop. A rigid two-piece box in uncoated off-white recycled paperboard, lid lifted and leaning against the base, a small circular blind-debossed emblem of four concentric slightly irregular rings on the lid, no text. Inside, a folded ivory cotton kurta wrapped in unbleached thin tissue printed with a faint repeating ring pattern at very low contrast. Beside the box: a drawstring garment bag in undyed natural cotton canvas with a plain cotton cord; a rectangular swing tag in beige textured handmade paper tied with undyed cotton string, the tag's centre holding a blank square area framed by fine concentric rings; a small folded card in deep forest-green uncoated stock. Soft diffused daylight, gentle realistic shadows, every material matte and tactile, no plastic, no gloss, no foil. Calm, precise, archival presentation, generous negative space --ar 4:5 --style raw --stylize 60 --v 7 --no text, letters, logo, QR code, barcode, plastic, glossy lamination, gold foil, ribbon bow, leaves, flowers

A photorealistic packaging mockup, 4:5 portrait, seen from above at a three-quarter angle on a pale raw-linen table. A rigid off-white uncoated paperboard box with its lid lifted, a small blind-debossed emblem of four concentric, slightly uneven rings on the lid. Inside, a folded ivory cotton kurta wrapped in thin unbleached tissue with a very faint repeating ring pattern. Next to it: an undyed cotton canvas drawstring bag, a beige handmade-paper swing tag tied with undyed cotton string with a blank square in its centre framed by fine rings, and a small folded card in deep forest green. Soft daylight, matte materials only, no plastic, no gloss, no foil, no text, no logos, no QR codes.



AI-generated image. Concept only.

Output review: use with three fixes. The unboxing reads as section 5.1 describes it: garment folded collar-up, ring-pattern tissue, canvas bag, tag, card. But:

1. **The embossed emblem is not the Ring Seal.** It has three rings and no cut. Replace it on the lid and the tag with the vector seal, or caption the image as an earlier concept.
2. **The folded card is olive (about #4D4B3A in shadow), not Heartwood (#1F3A2F).** Recolour it.
3. **The tag carries no Proof Strip or QR.** Add both in post, or the image shows a tag without the proof the brand is built on.

Post-production: place the real wordmark, the Proof Strip and a working QR in the tag's blank square; the emblem must match the Ring Seal drawing, so replace it with the vector if the model distorts it.

Prompt 3: Campaign card 1, brand story and mood

Purpose: the Heartwood idea as an image: the elder beneath the tree. **Format:** 4:5 portrait (social, pitch card).

Documentary-style portrait of an Indian man around 58 years old with a fuller build, grey stubble and silver-streaked hair, natural skin texture and visible laugh lines, sitting at ease on a low stone ledge beneath the aerial roots of an old banyan tree in a quiet village courtyard at early morning. He wears an unbleached ivory straight-cut cotton kurta with rolled sleeves and loose cotton trousers, relaxed and well-fitted, not slim. He looks off-frame toward something outside the picture, calm and present, one hand resting on his knee. Soft low sunlight filtering through the roots, warm neutral tones, deep shadows in the trunk showing bark texture. Composition with the man in the left third and the massive trunk filling the right, generous space above. Honest, unretouched, dignified, quiet --ar 4:5 --style raw --stylize 100 --v 7 --no young man, slim model, text, logo, sepia, vintage filter, heavy retouching, jewellery, looking at camera

A photorealistic documentary portrait, 4:5 portrait. An Indian man of about 58 with a fuller build, grey stubble, silver-streaked hair and natural, unretouched skin sits calmly on a low stone ledge beneath the hanging roots of an old banyan tree in a quiet village courtyard in early morning light. He wears a well-fitted, relaxed ivory cotton kurta with rolled sleeves. He looks away from the camera, one hand on his knee. Warm, soft light through the roots, visible bark texture, the man in the left third and the trunk filling the right. No sepia, no vintage filter, no text or logos.



AI-generated image. Concept only.

Output review: use, with one logged drift. The age (about 55–60), the gaze off-frame, the light, the bark texture and the unretouched skin all match. **The build does not:** the prompt asked for a fuller build and the model returned an average one. That is the drift the AI6 audit exists to catch; it is logged in 4.2.

Audit: requested age 55–60, build fuller, skin tone as generated; record the observed age band and build. Regenerate if the model slims him or makes him look under 45.

Prompt 4: Campaign card 2, product in context

Purpose: the Festive line at a family wedding; the occasion and the fit, together. **Format:** 4:5 portrait.

Candid documentary wedding photograph at an Indian family home in the evening before a ceremony. An Indian man around 55 with a broad, fuller build, greying hair and a trimmed grey beard, wearing a deep indigo linen kurta with a sleeveless raw-beige khadi Nehru jacket, well-fitted through the chest and waist, gently adjusts the collar of his adult son's cream sherwani in a narrow hallway. Strings of fresh marigolds in the doorway behind them, warm light from brass diyas and a bare bulb, soft motion in the background where relatives pass by. The father's expression is focused and proud, not posed. Natural skin texture, real fabric creases, true colour on the indigo, warm but not orange grading. Shot on 35mm lens, f/2, shallow depth of field, available light --ar 4:5 --style raw --stylize 90 --v 7 --no posing, looking at camera, text, logo, gold zari, heavy embroidery, sequins, slim model, teal-orange grade, oversaturation

A photorealistic candid wedding photograph, 4:5 portrait, evening at an Indian family home. A man of about 55 with a broad, fuller build, greying hair and a trimmed grey beard wears a well-fitted deep indigo linen kurta and a sleeveless raw-beige khadi Nehru jacket. In a narrow hallway he gently straightens the collar of his adult son's cream sherwani. Fresh marigold strings hang in the doorway, lit by warm brass lamps and a bare bulb; relatives blur past in the background. The father looks focused and proud, not posed, and neither looks at the camera. Natural skin, real fabric creases, true indigo colour, shallow depth of field. No text, logos, metallic embroidery or sequins.



AI-generated image. Concept only.

Output review: use, with the same drift. The occasion, the outfit, the action and the warm practical light are right, and neither man looks at the camera. The father is broad-shouldered but again not the fuller build asked for.

Likeness check. P3 and P4 produced what looks like the same man. A consistent "TARU man" helps a concept deck. But ASCI's final AI guidelines ban using a real person's likeness without consent, so run a reverse image search on both before they appear anywhere public, including LinkedIn.

Audit: two people; record age, build and skin tone for both. The son may be slim; the father must not be slimmed.

Prompt 5: Campaign card 3, brand values and impact

Purpose: the proof system as an image: the garment's life laid out ring by ring. This is the image for pillar 1, the QR proof page header and the "what certified organic means" social post. **Format:** 1:1 square.

Overhead flat-lay photograph on a dark oiled teak table, arranged as four concentric rings around a centre, like the growth rings of a tree cross-section. Outer ring: raw cotton bolls on dried stems. Second ring: soft tufts of ginned white cotton lint. Third ring: undyed ivory cotton yarn on small wooden cones and loose skeins. Fourth ring: small squares of woven unbleached organic cotton and linen fabric swatches with visible weave. Centre: a single neatly folded ivory cotton kurta with a mandarin collar. Beside each ring, a small blank cream index card placed at the ring's edge, no writing. Museum-archive precision, even spacing, soft top light with a gentle falloff to the corners, matte textures, true colour, calm and exact --ar 1:1 --style raw --stylize 70 --v 7 --no text, writing, labels with letters, logo, hands, leaves, plants, green tint, globe, clutter

A photorealistic overhead flat lay, square format, on a dark oiled teak table, arranged in four neat concentric rings around a centre like a tree's growth rings. The outer ring is raw cotton bolls on dried stems; the next is soft tufts of ginned white cotton; the next is undyed ivory yarn on small wooden cones and skeins; the inner ring is small squares of woven unbleached cotton and linen fabric. At the centre is one neatly folded ivory cotton kurta. A small blank cream card sits at the edge of each ring with nothing written on it. Precise museum-archive styling, soft even top light, matte textures, true colour. No text, no hands, no plants, no logos.



AI-generated image. Concept only.

Output review: strongest of the five. Four rings in the right order (bolls, ginned lint, yarn, woven fabric), the kurta at the centre, and four blank cards with no invented text. Two fixes: the yarn ring mixes cones and loose skeins, so it reads less clearly than the others; and the four cards run down the right edge rather than one beside each ring. Reposition the stage labels in post so each card points to its ring.

Post-production: set the four stage names (Farm · Gin · Mill · Garment) on the cards in IBM Plex Mono, with transaction-certificate reference placeholders. A live brand would replace this image with photographs of its real partners' materials; in this capstone it stays as a labelled concept.

4.2 Generation and audit log

Copy this table into `ai/eval/image_audit.csv` for the AI6 bias audit.

Prompt	Model and version	Seed	Date	Requested (age · build · skin)	Observed (age · build · Monk scale)	Drift?	Next step	Labelled
P1	[fill in]	[fill in]	30 Sep 2026	No people	No people	Stripe bolder than asked	Tone down in post	Yes, in this doc
P2	[fill in]	[fill in]	30 Sep 2026	No people	No people	Emblem 3 rings, no cut; card olive	Replace emblem; recolour card	Yes, in this doc
P3	[fill in]	[fill in]	30 Sep 2026	55–60 · fuller · not specified	~55–60 · average · ~6–7 (estimate)	Build	Regenerate	Yes, in this doc
P4	[fill in]	[fill in]	30 Sep 2026	55 · fuller · not specified	~55–60 · average, broad shoulders · ~6–7 (estimate)	Build	Regenerate	Yes, in this doc
P5	[fill in]	[fill in]	30 Sep 2026	No people	No people	Cards not beside their rings	Reposition labels in post	Yes, in this doc

Finding for the AI6 audit. In both people images the model kept the requested age and dropped the requested build. For the rerun, put the build first in the prompt, make it concrete ("heavy-set, broad waist and belly, about 90 kg"), and add "slim, athletic" to the exclusions. Log both runs so the before-and-after sits in the audit. The Monk-scale values above are estimates from the image; confirm them against the MST chart.

5. Applications and brand touchpoints

Every touchpoint has one job beyond looking right: to put the proof within reach at the moment a doubt could arise. The swing tag, the proof card and the QR page carry more of the brand than any advertisement.

5.1 Packaging and the unboxing experience

Packaging rule: no environmental claim is printed on any packaging ("recyclable", "plastic-free", "compostable") unless it has a D7 row and a certificate, for example an FSC licence for the board. Materials are chosen for how they behave; they are not advertised.

Packaging system

Component	Material and size	Graphics	Used for
Swing tag	85 × 55 mm, 450 gsm uncoated board tinted Raw Khadi, undyed cotton string	Front: Ring Seal with the QR inside it, wordmark below. Back: Proof Strip, then the Legal Metrology fields (maker, country of origin, consumer-care contact, size, MRP), fibre % and care symbols ready for the draft Textiles Committee rules	Every garment
Care label	Woven, 100% cotton, Kora ground, Ink text	Fibre composition, care symbols, size. The GOTS label appears only if the garment and the last processing unit are certified and the label use is approved under GOTS labelling rules	Every garment
Garment bag	Undyed cotton canvas drawstring, sized per line	Blind-debossed or single-colour Heartwood seal, no text	Everyday and Festive
Shipping mailer	Plain board mailer, Heartwood seal sticker as closure	Small wordmark; nothing that advertises contents	D2C orders
Rigid box	Two-piece, uncoated off-white board, lid 40 mm deep	Blind-debossed Ring Seal on the lid; Madder band on the base for Ceremonial	Ceremonial and gift sets
Tissue	Thin unbleached tissue	Ring pattern at 5% (Heartwood on Kora)	Festive and Ceremonial
Proof card	A6, 400 gsm, Heartwood ground, Kora text	"Your garment's trail": the four stages with certificate references and the QR	Every order

Component	Material and size	Graphics	Used for
Alteration voucher	A7, Raw Khadi card	Free alteration terms and how to claim	Every order
Fabric swatch card	A7 with a 30 × 30 mm swatch of the garment's fabric	Fibre %, weave, care	Ceremonial; any order on request, for the tailor

The unboxing sequence

Five moments, designed so the proof arrives after the pleasure, not before it.

1. **Arrive.** A plain mailer closed with the Heartwood seal sticker. Quiet on the doorstep.
2. **Open.** The seal sticker's notch lines up with a notch on the box edge: a small sign that nothing was opened in between.
3. **Reveal.** Tissue with the faint ring pattern; the garment folded collar-up, so the first thing he sees is the neckline and the fabric.
4. **Proof.** The proof card lies under the garment, not on top: the trail is there when he is curious, not pushed at him.
5. **Keep.** The alteration voucher and care card sit in a sleeve inside the lid, to be kept with the garment.

Gift edition. The proof card goes into a separate Heartwood envelope marked *For when you want to know*. No price appears anywhere in the box, and the invoice is emailed only to the buyer. The gifter can add a handwritten note on a Kora card; the brand never writes the sentiment for them.

Deliberately left out: fragrance (skin sensitivity and scent claims), glossy inserts, discount coupons for the next purchase, and plastic windows.

5.2 Digital and social media

Website

Page	Structure (top to bottom)	Key rule
Home	One hero image (real photography) with one line · the three occasion lines · "How we prove it" (the four rings) · fit promise · journal	One display line per screen

Page	Structure (top to bottom)	Key rule
Product page	Photos (on body in two builds, flat lay, 1:1 weave macro) · price · fit first : size by body measurements with a fuller-build guide · fabric and construction · the Proof Strip · alteration and return terms	Proof Strip fields are fed from the certificate database, never typed by hand
QR proof page	Garment ID and fabric · four stages as a vertical ring timeline (place, date, certificate reference, certifier) with each certificate viewable · plain-language "What this certificate covers, and what it doesn't" · "Report a concern" link	Loads in under 2 seconds on 4G; no sales content, no pop-ups, no sign-in
Fit guide	Body-measurement guide with illustrations of three builds · how alterations work · book a fitting	Never use "plus size"; sizes are sizes

Accessibility: WCAG 2.2 AA throughout; 16 px minimum body text; alt text on every image, describing the garment's fit and fabric; Hindi pages written, not machine-translated.

Social identity

Element	Guideline
Profile	Ring Seal in Kora on a Heartwood circle; one handle across Instagram, LinkedIn, YouTube and WhatsApp Business
Bio	"Certified-organic ethnic wear for men, cut for real builds. Proof on every tag." + link to the proof explainer (bio is a public claim: D7 row)
Grid rhythm	Three repeating post types in three columns: Proof (left, Heartwood grounds), Fit (centre, real photography), Occasion (right, line colour). The grid reads as order, not a mood board
Formats	Feed and carousels 1080 × 1350; stories and reels 1080 × 1920 with 250 px safe zones top and bottom

Element	Guideline
Type on social	Fraunces for one headline line (≥ 64 px on a 1080 canvas); IBM Plex Sans for body (≥ 32 px); Plex Mono for data
Captions	First line states the fact. No exclamation marks, no emojis, at most three hashtags at the end
Video	Natural sound or a quiet instrumental; burned-in subtitles in English and Hindi; no trending audio on proof content
AI content	Every AI image or video carries the "AI-generated image" label on the image and in the caption
Creators	Real customers or disclosed paid partners only; every paid post carries the platform's paid-partnership tag and an ad disclosure. No scripted health or comfort claims
Comments	Certification questions answered within 24 hours with the certificate link. Critical comments stay up; only abuse is removed

Content templates

Template	Pillar	Ground	Frequency
"What this certificate covers" (carousel)	Proof	Heartwood	Every two weeks
"Stage of the month" (a real farm, gin, mill or workshop partner, named)	Proof	Real photography	Monthly
"Fit notes" (one garment on two or three builds)	Fit	Kora	Weekly
"Alteration stories" (a customer's garment altered, with permission)	Fit	Real photography	Monthly
"The occasion" (a festival or ceremony, and what to wear)	Occasion	Line colour	Seasonal, 3 weeks before the occasion

Email and WhatsApp

- **Order confirmation:** the garment's proof page link is in the first line, before delivery details.
- **Delivery message (WhatsApp Business):** "Your [garment] is on its way. Its fabric trail: [link]."
- **Newsletter:** monthly, one story, one garment, one proof explainer. Plain layout, Kora ground, one image.

5.3 Environmental and physical touchpoints

The brand's early channels are pop-ups at clubs and exhibitions, corporate gifting and, possibly, shop-in-shop bays (channel sequence **[Pending evidence]** from the economics model). Physical spaces follow one principle: the proof and the fabric can be touched.

Touchpoint	Specification
Pop-up (3 × 3 m module)	Teak frame with Raw Khadi fabric panels; one garment rail per occasion line; the Proof Table at the front: the real four-stage materials laid out in rings, with the certificate binder open beside them; a trial booth at the back
Trial booth	Seat inside; mirror at least 90 cm wide; 3000 K warm light with CRI ≥ 90 so fabric colour is true; hooks at two heights; an alteration chalk and tape on a shelf
Alteration station	A tailor on site at every pop-up, marking with chalk: the Grain Line made physical
Shop-in-shop bay (2.4 m)	Heartwood back panel with the blind wordmark; Kora shelving; a "touch library" of fabric swatches at hand height; the QR proof explainer at eye level; no mannequin torsos (fit is shown on people)
Signage	Fraunces for names, IBM Plex Sans for information, cut or engraved in wood or printed on linen; no acrylic, no backlit boxes
Staff	Everyday kurta in Kora Cotton; a pocket "proof card" with three things to say: what the certificate covers, how to scan the trail, how alterations work. Staff never describe skin or health benefits

Touchpoint	Specification
Corporate gifting	Rigid Ceremonial box; the client's logo may appear on the message card only, never on the garment or the TARU box lid
Home trials (Ceremonial)	A fitter visits with three sizes and fabric swatches, in a Heartwood canvas garment carrier
Stationery	Business cards 85 × 55 mm on the tag stock; invoices carry the certifier and licence number in the Proof Strip

Materials palette for spaces: oiled teak, raw khadi, limewashed walls, brass details that age. No plastic laminates, no chrome, no fake plants.

Appendix: claim library and open decisions

A. Claim library

The working list for the claims substantiation matrix (D7). Every line runs through the Claims Guardrail (AI4) and a person before first use.

Claim wording	Status	Condition before use
"Organic cotton. GOTS certified, licence no. [X], certified by [body]."	Usable once certified	Garment meets the ≥ 95% grade; last processing unit certified; label use approved
"Made with [X]% organic cotton."	Usable once certified	≥ 70% certified organic fibre, percentage from the transaction certificate
"Scan to see where your fabric came from."	Usable once the trail is live	Every stage linked to a real transaction certificate
"Cut with more room through the chest and waist."	Usable	Graded block documented against the standard block
"Free alterations within 30 days."	Usable	Service terms published
"Soft through a six-hour function."	Conditional	Documented wear trial; wording matched to the trial result
"Every thread, accounted for."	Conditional	Trail covers all fibres including sewing thread

Claim wording	Status	Condition before use
"Rooted in nature. Refined by time."	On hold	"Nature" needs a qualifier or its own substantiation
"Eco-friendly", "sustainable", "natural", "green", "conscious" (unqualified)	Banned	CCPA 2024 generic-term rule
"Chemical-free", "toxin-free", "hypoallergenic", "good for sensitive skin"	Banned	Absolute and health claims without test evidence
"India's first / only certified-organic menswear brand"	Banned	Unsubstantiable and untrue
"Organic bamboo", "organic lyocell"	Banned	Processed fibres cannot carry an organic claim

B. Open decisions

Decision	Options	Decided by	Changes
Frame of reference	A: premium ethnic wear that is certified organic · B: certified-organic clothing for Indian occasions	Kano + claim test	Section 1.6, pillar order, hero lines
Lead pillar	Proof · Comfort · Fit	Claim test (B vs A, C vs B); Kano	Section 2.4, campaign
Visual route	Route 1 Heritage (this document) · Route 2 Quiet Proof · Route 3 Occasion	Survey Block F vote	Section 3; palette weighting may shift
Tagline	Four candidates (section 2.3)	Comprehension check with target buyers from the interview pool	Wordmark lockup, campaign

C. What a live launch would add (outside this capstone's scope)

Listed to show the brand system knows what production requires. None of these is a task for this project.

Step	Why a real brand would need it
Trademark search and filing for TARU in Class 25 (clothing)	Name clearance before any public use
Printed Pantone proofs on the actual box, tag and paper stocks	On-screen colour matches shift on uncoated stock
Mill lab dips for garment colours	Fabric is dyed to a physical swatch, not to HEX values
GOTS-certified suppliers and transaction certificates	Every organic claim in D7 depends on them
Wear trial for the comfort claim	"Soft through a six-hour function" needs test evidence
Real partner and customer photography	Replaces every AI concept image in section 4
Social handles and domain	Presence under one name